

FreeBSD, and ensure that your system meets those requirements before you proceed with attempting an installation. You will find them right after this introduction.

With that out of the way, let's get started with installing FreeBSD!

Minimum hardware requirements

All software have minimum hardware requirements. This is the minimum configuration of hardware required to make the software run smoothly. For FreeBSD you will need one of the following processors:

- **amd64:** The essential requirement for FreeBSD is a 64-bit processor. While it can run on 32-bit CPUs, it's happiest on a 64-bit one. Thankfully, this is the most common type of processor in most systems these days. 64-bit CPUs are also known as Intel64 or x86-64 processors. In the Intel family, all processors after Intel Core 2 have been 64-bit processors.
- **i386 with floating point:** This is an older generation of processors, but FreeBSD supports even i386 processors that contain a floating-point unit. This means that in the Intel family, all processors after Intel 486 are supported. CPUs with this type of processor typically have Physical Address Extensions (PAE). PAE enables FreeBSD to detect more than 4 GB of memory and thus be used by the system.
- **PowerPC:** PowerPC is an old IBM processor that was used in Apple computers in the 1990s. All the New World ROM Macintosh computers with USB contain this processor and can be used for FreeBSD. If your machine has more than one CPU, SMP is also supported. A maximum of only 2 GB can be used.
- **sparc64:** The SPARC64V is a processor designed by Fujitsu. FreeBSD supports only selective sparc64 processors.

Apart from these processors, the minimum requirements for FreeBSD are 96 MB of RAM and 1.5 GB of free storage. However, at least 4 GB of RAM and 8 GB of free storage is recommended for smooth usage of all applications.

Pre-installation

The following are the major pre-installation tasks that need to be carried out for FreeBSD.

- **Create a data backup:** As with any other major software or operating system, you must create a physical, external backup of your data. The